Membership of the

U3A Port Alfred Club

offers you

- Regular lectures from local and guest speakers, at least ten and possibly twenty times per year.
- The opportunity to attend any number of classes on any of the subjects available.
- Monthly newsletters with details of all U3A lectures, classes, and other activities.

More information and application forms can be obtained from our websites:

www.u3a.org.za, www.myu3a.org, and www.worldu3a.org

Email:

u3a-port-alfred@googlegroups.com

Phone: 046 604 0200

Post:
Secretary of U3A Port Alfred
Private Bag 2125,
Port Alfred 6170
South Africa

University of the Third Age
Port Alfred

Sample list of topics offered

It's about Time

Training and using Guide Dogs

Internet of Things, Clouds, and AI

Flowers of Namibia

Nostalgia Unplugged: Sixty Years in the Kowie

The Stars are Ours

WW1 through the eyes of Poets

Services Offered

Knowledgeable Speakers

Special Interest Groups

Recommended Adult Courses

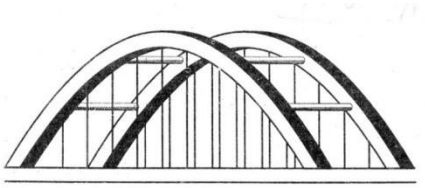
Monthly Newsletter

U3A

Retired?

What next?

Want to keep your mind and body active – and enjoy social activities?



"Learning for leisure and pleasure"

U3A Port Alfred

What is U3A?

The "**University of the Third Age**", or **U3A** as it is usually known, is a learning and social community organized by and for people who can best be described as in active retirement – the "**Third Age**" of their lives

The overall aim is to provide members with both the stimulus of mental activity and the satisfaction of suitable activities with people of a similar age.

No qualifications are required to join a U3A, nor are any qualifications awarded. Individuals learn what they like, at the pace they prefer. **The class tutors are not trained teachers or lecturers and do not require any special qualification.** All tutors are volunteers and receive no remuneration.

The U3A will enable members to take up new interests and to extend old ones; it will offer the joy of learning for its own sake, unrestricted by the requirements of vocation or the desire for qualification.

The concept is best explained by considering the two parts of the name: "University" and "Third Age".

University

The **University of the Third Age** was founded in France in 1972 to improve the quality of life for older people. The idea spread rapidly, and many other universities and similar organisations followed the practice.

In 1981 the U3A concept was introduced into England by a group based in Cambridge University. The English U3A adopted a self-help or mutual aid university model – there would be *no distinction between the teachers and the taught*.

Tutors and activity facilitators are ordinary members who have volunteered to assist in the operation of U3A by conducting classes, discussions, or facilitating activities. Tutors or group leaders simply need the ability to share with others the interests which they may have pursued for many years.

Classes and activity groups are quite informal. The emphasis is on being friendly and informal. The motto of our U3A is: "*Learning for leisure and pleasure*".

The Third Age

The "Third Age", coming after the age of youth and the age of work and home making, can be an exciting stage of life, when the heavy demands within the home and workplace have been fulfilled and there is now time to do something for yourself. It is a time when seniors can participate in interesting activities enriched by social interaction with persons of similar age and interests. Consequently, it is generally applied to members of society in the 50+ age group.

What we offer

We offer lectures on interesting topics twice per month, and can assist in identifying useful (and generally, free) courses from Massive Open Online Courses (MOOC). There are Special Interest Groups (SIG) which are formed from time to time.

The U3A Port Alfred has no office or regular staff. All administration activities are carried out by members of a management committee in a voluntary capacity.

Costs

Annual membership fee	R50
Membership fee for couples	R80
Meeting fee for members	R5
Meeting fee for visitors	R10

This membership fee entitles members to attend any number of classes, social activities, and regular information meetings. It is payable in January of each year. These activities usually include tea/coffee.

Venues

All presentations take place in the Settlers Park Retirement Village Don Powis Hall. The entrance is in Horton Road, Port Alfred.

Times and dates

Presentations are generally of one hour duration

There are usually two meetings a month, in the morning of the second and fourth Thursday of the month at 09h30 for 10h00. The meeting usually ends between 11h00 and 12h00.

We look forward to your attendance at our meetings.

(Revised: 2025-02-06)